MINDING THE COUNTRY

BECAUSE he remains, after a career-long alliance, Modi's most supreme *senapati* and sword-arm. This covers all political matters, including dealing with the RSS and its affiliates on policy, harvesting turncoats, tamping down on any crisis (like Manipur, most recently), and handling everything from the big picture to the slightest nuance as chief strategist of every poll campaign

BECAUSE as home minister, the onus is on him to keep the slate clean on terror and extremism, inter-state gangsters and Maoist insurgency while also monitoring peace talks with separatist outfits in the Northeast and being de facto administrator of J&K

HOMEBOUND **Shah is the only minister in the Union cabinet who has not travelled abroad since he took office**

BECAUSE he's the only minister who sits with PM Modi on the appointments committee of the cabinet (ACC)



←2

AMIT SHAH, 58

UNION MINISTER OF HOME AFFAIRS

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE



Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

3

MOHAN BHAGWAT, 72

SARSANGHCHALAK, RSS

↑

DATTATREYA HOSABALE, 68

SARKARYAVAH, RSS

CONSCIENCE KEEPERS

BECAUSE Bhagwat's views, as Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh supremo, are a veritable policy directive to the Centre as well as the 16 states the BJP controls. The Sangh influence is visible in policy initiatives such as the construction of the Ram mandir in Ayodhya, abrogation of Article 370, anti-conversion laws and the BJP's commitment to bring in the UCC (uniform civil code)

BECAUSE as the RSS chief executive, Hosabale deals with the everyday minutiae in the work of the Sangh movement. His lieutenants are in crucial positions in the BJP, driving the party's national agenda—and, by extension, the Sangh's

CAST THE NET WIDE **The RSS now has wings in almost every district, making it India's largest social body**

BECAUSE While the RSS dons the rajguru robes, Hosabale's proximity to Modi helps smooth out any spats between Sangh affiliates and the government